

OFF THE GRID

2026 & 2027 OFFICIAL RATING FORM

MIDDLE SCHOOL

Judges: Using minimal (1-4 points), adequate (5-8 points), or exemplary (9-10 points) performance levels as a guideline in the rating form, record the scores earned for the event criteria in the column spaces to the right. The X1 or X2 notation in the criteria column is a multiplier factor for determining the points earned. (Example: an "adequate" score of 7 for an X1 criterion = 7 points; an "adequate" score of 7 for an X2 criterion = 14 points.) A score of zero (0) is acceptable if the minimal performance for any criterion is not met.

Go/No Go Specifications

- Before judging the entry, ensure that the items below are present; indicate presence with a check mark in the box.
- If an item is missing, leave the box next to the item blank and place a check mark in the box labeled ENTRY NOT EVALUATED.
- If a check mark is placed in the ENTRY NOT EVALUATED box, the entry is not to be judged.

- ☐ TIER 1 – Display and model are present
- ☐ TIER 2 – Documentation portfolio is present
- ☐ ENTRY NOT EVALUATED

TIER 1 – DISPLAY (50 points)				Record scores in the column spaces below.
CRITERIA	Minimal performance	Adequate performance	Exemplary performance	
	1-4 points	5-8 points	9-10 points	
Display Components (X1)	Display is unorganized and/or is missing three (3) or more components.	Display has most components and is generally organized; it has sufficient content.	All components are included in the display content and the organization is excellent.	
Communication of Solution (X3)	The description of the country and design is unclear or vague; there is little to no mention of the sustainable design features.	The description of the country and design of the style are included; however, some sustainable design features are missing.	The description of the country and design of the style are clear, effective, and convincing.	
Creativity (X1)	Display lacks originality; none or very few design principles are integrated in the display.	Some resourcefulness and ingenuity are evident in the display; some essential design principles are generally used.	There is clear evidence of an inventive, unique, and creative display; essential design principles and elements are integrated.	
TIER 1 – DISPLAY SUBTOTAL (50 points)				

TIER 1 – MODEL DESIGN (40 points)				Record scores in the column spaces below.
CRITERIA	Minimal performance	Adequate performance	Exemplary performance	
	1-4 points	5-8 points	9-10 points	
Effectiveness of Design (X1)	The design is ineffective in meeting the needs of the challenge.	The design is somewhat effective in meeting the needs of the challenge.	The design is clearly effective in meeting the needs of the challenge.	
Aesthetic Appeal and Functionality (X1)	There is little to no evidence of consideration of aesthetics and curb appeal in the design; systems in the model do not match or work with the design.	There is some evidence that aesthetics and curb appeal have been considered in the design; most systems in the model match or work with the design.	There is clear evidence that aesthetics and curb appeal are fully and effectively integrated into the design; all systems in the model work with the design.	
Creativity and Innovation (X1)	The design lacks originality and exhibits few, if any, creative and/or innovative applications.	Some unique, innovative, and creative concepts are incorporated in the overall design.	Unique, creative, and innovative approaches are fully incorporated into the design.	

TIER 1 – MODEL DESIGN (40 points) – continued				
Model Design (X1)	The model is not informative and does not effectively nor accurately represent the design.	Most of the model is informative and accurately represents the design.	The model effectively displays the solution to the challenge and accurately represents the design.	
TIER 1 – MODEL DESIGN SUBTOTAL (40 points)				
Rules violations (a deduction of 20% of the total possible points for the above sections) must be initialed by the judge, coordinator, and manager of the event. Record the deduction in the space to the right. Indicate the rule violated: _____				
TIER 1 – SUBTOTAL (90 points)				

TIER 2 – DOCUMENTATION PORTFOLIO (80 points)				Record scores in the column spaces below.
CRITERIA	Minimal performance 1-4 points	Adequate performance 5-8 points	Exemplary performance 9-10 points	
Portfolio Components (X1)	Portfolio is unorganized and/or is missing three (3) or more components.	Portfolio is missing one (1) or two (2) components and/or is loosely organized.	Portfolio has all required components in order and is well organized.	
Description of Design Interpretation (X1)	The description of the design and style is unclear or vague; includes little or no mention of the sustainable design features.	The description of the design and explanation of the style are included; they are adequately presented.	The descriptions and merits of the design, and an explanation of the style, are clear, effective, and convincing.	
Description of the Chosen Country (X1)	There is little or no evidence of research done; the country's environment, climate, natural resources, and economy were not addressed clearly or at all.	Most, but not all, of the required areas of research are present and documented; some aspects are missing.	All of the research areas are clearly documented and well presented.	
Description of Alternative Solutions (X1)	The team fails to articulate alternative solutions and/or why the chosen solution was utilized.	The team makes an attempt at outlining other potential solutions and somewhat explains the choice of the solution presented.	The team highlights alternatives to the proposed solution and is able to logically convey why the chosen solution was selected.	
Bill of Materials (X1)	Many elements are missing or incomplete.	Most, but not all, elements are included.	All elements are included, and are detailed and explained clearly.	
Drawings (X1)	A few of the required drawings are present, but they are lacking in quality.	Most, but not all, of the required drawings are included and are in the proper format.	All required drawings are included and in the proper format.	
Resources/References (X1)	There is little to no effort to provide resources or references.	Resources and references are included and are somewhat credible.	There is clear evidence of the appropriate use of applicable resources and references.	
Work Log (X1)	The Work Log lacks major elements of documentation.	The Work Log is somewhat complete, and generally reflects the time and work necessary for the project.	The Work Log completely and accurately reflects the time and work necessary for the project.	
TIER 2 – DOCUMENTATION PORTFOLIO SUBTOTAL (80 points)				
Rules violations (a deduction of 20% of the total possible points for the above sections) must be initialed by the judge, coordinator, and manager of the event. Record the deduction in the space to the right. Indicate the rule violated: _____				

PRELIMINARY SUBTOTAL (170 points)**SEMIFINAL PRESENTATION/INTERVIEW (50 points)**

CRITERIA	Minimal performance	Adequate performance	Exemplary performance
	1-4 points	5-8 points	9-10 points
Organization (X1)	Participant(s) seem unorganized and unprepared for the presentation; illogical explanation of the problem and solution is presented.	Participant(s) is/are generally prepared for the presentation; explanation of the problem and solution are generally communicated.	Presentation is logical and easy to follow; the problem and solution are communicated in a concise manner.
Articulation (X1)	Communication of the design project is unclear, unorganized, and or illogical; leadership and/or 21 st century skills are not evident.	Communication of the design project is somewhat logical and clear; leadership and/or 21 st century skills are somewhat evident.	Communication of the design project is clear, concise, and logical; leadership and/or 21 st century skills are clearly evident.
Delivery (X1)	The participant(s) is/are verbose and/or uncertain in its presentation/ interview; participants' posture, gestures, and lack of eye contact diminish the presentation/interview.	The participant(s) is/are somewhat well-spoken and clear in its presentation/interview; participants' posture, gestures, and eye contact are acceptable in the presentation/ interview.	The participant(s) is/are well-spoken and distinct in its presentation/ interview; participants' posture, gestures, and eye contact result in a polished, natural, and effective presentation/interview.
Knowledge (X2)	Participant(s) exhibit little understanding of the concepts in their project; answers to questions may be vague.	Participant(s) exhibit a general understanding of the concepts in their project.	Participant(s) show clear evidence of a thorough understanding of the project.

Record scores
in the column
spaces below.**SEMIFINAL PRESENTATION/INTERVIEW SUBTOTAL (50 points)**

Rules violations (a deduction of 20% of the total possible points for the above sections) must be initialed by the judge, coordinator, and manager of the event. Record the deduction in the space to the right.

Indicate the rule violated: _____

SEMIFINAL SUBTOTAL (50 points)

To arrive at the TOTAL score, add any subtotals and subtract rules violation points, as necessary.

TOTAL (220 points)

Comments:

I certify these results to be true and accurate to the best of my knowledge.

JUDGE

Printed name: _____ Signature: _____